GET FIT WITH ME

02

WEEKS

BEGINNER GUIDE

The Gym Girl Confidence Kit

Everything you need to walk into the gym and know exactly what to do.

Tap to open the interactive program →

Danielle Dawson

14 CHAPTERS · 2-WEEK PLAN · BEGINNER

How to use this book

This book is the companion to your interactive app. The app is the fastest way to train: it logs every set, remembers your weights, runs your rest timer and charts your progress. This PDF gives you the same material in a format you can read, print and fill in.

Tap here to open your interactive program →

The interactive program tracks every set, runs your rest timer, charts your progress and includes every chapter with quizzes. On your phone, tap *Share → Add to Home Screen* so it opens like an app.

This PDF is interactive. Tap any entry in the table of contents to jump to it, use your PDF reader's bookmarks panel to navigate, and fill in the workbook pages at the back directly in Adobe Acrobat, Apple Books/Preview, or most PDF apps. Your entries save with the file.

This program is for educational purposes and is not medical advice. Consult your doctor before starting a new exercise or nutrition plan, especially if you are pregnant, injured or have a medical condition. Stop any exercise that causes pain.

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PART I

The Guide

14 chapters. Read Chapters 1–4 before you start, and use the rest as a reference.

CHAPTER 1

Welcome: You Belong in That Gym

Real talk: I was once the girl who walked into the gym, did ten minutes on the treadmill and left because I didn't know what to do and felt like everyone was watching. Gym anxiety is incredibly common, and it keeps so many women from goals they could absolutely reach.

This guide gives you the knowledge that makes confidence possible: what everything is, how it works, what to say, how to plan your workout, and a two-week plan that eases you in.

How to use this kit

1. Read Chapters 1–5 before your first visit.
2. Pack your bag with the Gym Bag checklist.
3. Follow the 2-Week Plan, one day at a time.
4. Use the Machine Guide and Exercise Library as reference in the gym.
5. Journal after each session. You'll be amazed how fast your confidence grows.

CHAPTER 2

Understanding Gym Anxiety

Why it happens

Your brain is wired to feel anxious in unfamiliar social situations where you might be judged. A gym checks every box: new environment, unfamiliar equipment, and people who seem to know what they're doing.

The truth about "everyone is watching"

Psychologists call it the **spotlight effect**: we consistently overestimate how much other people notice us. In reality, most people in the gym are focused on their own sets, their music and themselves in the mirror.

Anxiety shrinks with exposure

Every time you go and nothing bad happens, your brain learns the gym is safe. Most women report their anxiety drops significantly after just **6–8 visits**. Your job is to get to visit #8.

> **The 2-minute rule:** On days when anxiety is high, commit to just walking in and doing one exercise. You can leave after that. You almost never will.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

What is the "spotlight effect"?

A. A gym lighting technique

B. Overestimating how much other people notice you

C. A warm-up exercise

Answer: B. The spotlight effect is our tendency to believe others are watching and judging us far more than they actually are.

CHAPTER 3

Before Your First Visit

Pick the right time

TIME	BUSYNESS
5–7 AM	Quiet. Regulars, focused crowd
9 AM–3 PM (weekdays)	Quietest overall
4–7 PM (weekdays)	Peak time
Weekend mornings	Busy
After 8 PM	Quiet

Go during quiet hours for your first few visits.

Take the tour

Most gyms offer a free orientation. Ask for one: "Hi, I'm new. Could someone show me where everything is?" Staff do this every day.

What to wear

- Clothes you feel good in and can move freely in. Confidence matters more than brand.
- **Shoes:** flat, stable sneakers for lifting (or Converse-style shoes). Running shoes with thick cushions are less stable for squats and deadlifts.
- Hair tied back and away from your face.

Have a plan before you walk in

Never walk in without knowing what you'll do. Open the 2-Week Plan, read today's workout and look up any exercise you don't know in the library before you arrive.

CHAPTER 4

The Gym Layout: Zones Explained

ZONE	WHAT'S THERE	WHAT IT'S FOR
Cardio area	Treadmills, bikes, stair climbers, ellipticals	Warm-ups and cardio
Machine area	Selectorized machines (pin-loaded weight stacks)	Beginner-friendly strength training
Free-weight area	Dumbbells, benches, adjustable benches	Most of your strength training
Squat racks / platforms	Barbells, power racks, plates	Squats, deadlifts, hip thrusts
Cable area	Cable stations with adjustable pulleys	Kickbacks, rows, pushdowns, flyes
Stretching / turf area	Mats, foam rollers, bands, sleds	Warm-ups, core, stretching

CHAPTER 5

Equipment 101

Barbells

- **Standard Olympic barbell:** 45 lb (20 kg), 7 ft long.
- **Women's Olympic bar:** 33–35 lb (15 kg), thinner grip. Some gyms have these.
- **EZ curl bar & fixed barbells:** smaller pre-weighted bars, usually on a rack.

Plates

Common plates are 2.5, 5, 10, 25, 35 and 45 lb. Always load the same weight on each side and **use collars (clips)** to keep plates from sliding.

Pin-loaded machines

1. Adjust the seat and pads to fit your body (most have a pop pin or lever).
2. Insert the pin into the weight stack at your chosen weight.
3. Do your set with control. Don't let the stack slam.

Cable machines

- **Pulley height:** pull the pin on the side column and slide it up or down.
- **Attachments:** handles, rope, straight bar, ankle strap. These are usually hanging on a rack nearby.
- **Weight:** the pin in the stack. Some cable machines have a 2:1 ratio, so the number on the stack doesn't match other machines. Just track your own numbers.

Smith machine

A barbell on a fixed track. To unrack, rotate your wrists to unhook the bar from the slots; rotate back to rehook. It's great for beginners because the path is guided.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

How much does a standard Olympic barbell weigh?

A. 20 lb

B. 45 lb

C. 100 lb

Answer: B. A standard Olympic bar is 45 lb (20 kg). Women's bars are usually 33–35 lb (15 kg).

CHAPTER 6

Gym Etiquette: The Unwritten Rules

DO	DON'T
Re-rack your weights where you found them	Leave plates on the bar or dumbbells on the floor
Wipe down equipment after use	Leave sweat on benches
Ask "how many sets do you have left?"	Take equipment someone is clearly using
Let people work in between your sets	Sit on a machine scrolling during long rests
Keep your stuff compact	Spread your bag, bottle and jacket across 3 machines
Stand back from the dumbbell rack after grabbing weights	Lift right in front of the rack, blocking others
Wear headphones	Play music from your speaker
Ask before filming near others	Film people without permission

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

You want the cable machine but someone is resting between sets. What do you say?

A. Nothing, just take it

B. "How many sets do you have left?"

C. Wait silently for 20 minutes

Answer: B. Asking how many sets are left (or to work in) is normal, polite gym etiquette.

CHAPTER 7

Gym Scripts: What to Say

Knowing exactly what to say removes most of the stress. Save these:

When you want a machine someone is using:

> "Hey, how many sets do you have left?" or "Mind if I work in?"

When you need a spot:

> "Could you spot me for one set? It's 8 reps. Just help if I get stuck."

When someone wants to work in with you:

> "Sure! I've got two sets left, we can alternate."

When you can't find something:

> (To staff) "Where can I find the ankle straps / the hip thrust pad?"

When someone gives unsolicited advice:

> "Thanks! I'm following my coach's program." Then return to your set.

When someone keeps talking and you want to train:

> Point to your headphones, smile: "Sorry, I'm in the zone!"

When someone is making you uncomfortable:

> You don't owe anyone conversation. Move away, and **report it to staff**. Gyms take harassment seriously.

CHAPTER 8

How a Workout Is Structured

Every good workout follows a similar flow:

PART	TIME	WHAT YOU DO
1. General warm-up	5 min	Light cardio until you're warm
2. Activation & ramp-up	5 min	Bands, bridges, lighter sets of your first exercise
3. Main lifts	20–30 min	Biggest, hardest exercises first, when you're freshest
4. Accessories	15–20 min	Smaller exercises for specific muscles
5. Finisher / core (optional)	5 min	High-rep pump work or core
6. Cooldown	5 min	Easy walk and stretch

CHAPTER 9

Reading a Program Like a Pro

NOTATION	WHAT IT MEANS
3 × 12	3 sets of 12 reps
3 × 10–12	3 sets of 10–12 reps. Use double progression (add weight once you hit 12 on all sets)
/side	Do the reps on each side
RIR 2	Stop when you could do about 2 more reps
Rest 90s	Rest 90 seconds between sets
AMRAP	As Many Reps As Possible (with good form)
Superset	Two exercises back to back with no rest between them
Tempo 3-1-1	3 sec lowering, 1 sec pause, 1 sec lifting
Drop set	Finish a set, immediately reduce weight ~20–30% and continue

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

What does "3 × 10–12, RIR 2" mean?

A. 3 reps of 10–12 sets

B. 3 sets of 10–12 reps, stopping about 2 reps before failure

C. Rest 2 minutes

Answer: B. Sets × reps, and RIR is how many good reps you have left in the tank at the end of the set.

CHAPTER 10

Choosing Weights as a Beginner

The right weight lets you finish all your reps with good form and feel challenged in the last 2–3 reps.

1. Start lighter than you think.
2. Do a set and ask: "Could I do 2–3 more good reps?"
3. If you could do 5+ more, go heavier next set. If you couldn't finish with good form, go lighter.
4. Write down the weight in your log. Next time, start there.

> **Remember:** Everyone in that gym started with light weights. The only way to lift heavy is to start where you are.

CHAPTER 11

Filming Your Workouts

Filming helps you check your form and creates content if you want it.

- Set your phone up **out of walkways** (on the floor, a tripod or a bench you're using).
- Film from the **side** for squats, hinges and presses, and from the **front** for knee tracking.
- Don't film other people without permission.
- Compare your videos to the technique cues in the Exercise Library.

CHAPTER 12

Safety & Boundaries

- Trust your instincts. If something or someone feels off, leave the area or tell staff.
- Most gyms have a code of conduct. Unwanted comments, touching or filming can be reported.
- Use the buddy system at night: walk out with a friend or ask staff to watch you to your car.
- Share your location with a friend if you train very early or late.

CHAPTER 13

Building the Habit

Confidence comes from consistency. These strategies help it stick:

- **Schedule it** like an appointment, with the same days and times each week.
- **Habit stack:** "After I drop the kids off, I drive to the gym." Link the gym to an existing routine.
- **Pack your bag the night before** and leave it by the door.
- **Minimum viable workout:** on hard days, do just the first 2 exercises. Showing up keeps the habit alive.
- **Track it:** check off every workout. Seeing your streak grow is powerful.

CHAPTER 14

After the 2 Weeks

You did it. Now you know the gym, the equipment and the etiquette, and you've proved to yourself that you belong there. Next step: a structured program built for results. My **Glute Specialist Program** and **Press Like A Boss** program pick up exactly where this kit leaves off.

PART II

The Program

Every workout, week by week. Log your sets in the app or in the fillable workbook at the back of this book.

Week 1

LEARN PHASE

Light weights. The only goal is to learn each station and leave proud.

Day 1 · Machines

Guided machines: zero guesswork.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Leg Press	2 × 12	3–4	75s
Lat Pulldown	2 × 12	3–4	75s
Machine Chest Press	2 × 12	3–4	75s
Lying Hamstring Curl	2 × 12	3–4	75s
Hip Abduction Machine	2 × 12	3–4	75s
Treadmill Incline Walk	1 × 10 min	—	—

Day 2 · Dumbbells

Claim a bench and a set of dumbbells.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Goblet Squat	2 × 12	3–4	75s
DB Chest Press	2 × 12	3–4	75s
Single-Arm DB Row	2 × 12 /side	3–4	75s
Romanian Deadlift	2 × 12	3–4	75s
DB Shoulder Press	2 × 12	3–4	75s

Day 3 · Cables

Learn the most versatile station in the gym.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Cable Kickback	2 × 12 /side	3–4	75s
Seated Cable Row	2 × 12	3–4	75s
Face Pulls	2 × 12	3–4	75s
Tricep Rope Pushdown	2 × 12	3–4	75s
Glute Bridge	2 × 12	3–4	75s
Treadmill Incline Walk	1 × 10 min	—	—

Week 2

OWN IT PHASE

Add a set and go slightly heavier. Same stations, more confidence.

Day 1 · Machines

Guided machines: zero guesswork.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Leg Press	3 × 10–12	2–3	75s
Lat Pulldown	3 × 10–12	2–3	75s
Machine Chest Press	3 × 10–12	2–3	75s
Lying Hamstring Curl	3 × 10–12	2–3	75s
Hip Abduction Machine	3 × 10–12	2–3	75s
Treadmill Incline Walk	1 × 15 min	—	—

Day 2 · Dumbbells

Claim a bench and a set of dumbbells.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Goblet Squat	3 × 10–12	2–3	75s
DB Chest Press	3 × 10–12	2–3	75s
Single-Arm DB Row	3 × 10–12 /side	2–3	75s
Romanian Deadlift	3 × 10–12	2–3	75s
DB Shoulder Press	3 × 10–12	2–3	75s

Day 3 · Cables

Learn the most versatile station in the gym.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Cable Kickback	3 × 10–12 /side	2–3	75s
Seated Cable Row	3 × 10–12	2–3	75s
Face Pulls	3 × 10–12	2–3	75s
Tricep Rope Pushdown	3 × 10–12	2–3	75s
Glute Bridge	3 × 10–12	2–3	75s
Treadmill Incline Walk	1 × 15 min	—	—

PART III

Exercise Library

Setup, execution, cues, common mistakes and swaps for all 16 exercises in this program.

Cable Kickback

Glutes · Glute max (upper fibers), glute med · Equipment: Cable machine, ankle strap

SETUP

1. Attach an ankle strap at the lowest pulley setting and secure it to your working ankle.
2. Face the machine, hold the frame, and hinge forward slightly with a soft standing knee.

EXECUTION

1. Keeping your torso still, kick the working leg back and slightly out (about 30° from center).
2. Stop when your glute is fully squeezed — before your lower back arches.
3. Hold for 1 second, then return slowly until the weight stack almost touches.

CUES

- Back and slightly out
- Hips square to the machine
- Squeeze, don't swing

COMMON MISTAKES

- Arching the back to get more range
- Using momentum
- Rotating the hips open
- Too much weight — this is a feel exercise

EASIER / HARDER

Banded Kickback or Dumbbell Kickback / 2-sec pause at peak contraction

SWAPS

Glute Kickback Machine, Dumbbell Kickback

DB Chest Press

Upper · Pecs, front delts, triceps · Equipment: Flat bench, dumbbells

SETUP

1. Sit on the end of the bench with the dumbbells standing on your thighs.
2. Lie back and use your knees to 'kick' the dumbbells up to your chest, one at a time if needed.
3. Pinch your shoulder blades together and down, plant your feet, and keep a slight natural arch.

EXECUTION

1. Press the dumbbells up and slightly together until your arms are straight (not locked hard).
2. Lower under control to chest level with elbows about 45° from your body.
3. At the bottom, the dumbbells should be roughly in line with your lower chest.
4. Press up again, keeping your shoulder blades pinned the whole time.

CUES

- Shoulder blades in your back pockets
- Elbows at 45°, not flared at 90°
- Push yourself away from the dumbbells

COMMON MISTAKES

- Flaring the elbows straight out
- Losing the shoulder-blade position at the top
- Bouncing at the bottom
- Dropping the dumbbells out to the sides after the set

EASIER / HARDER

Machine Chest Press or Push-Ups / Paused DB Bench Press or 3-sec lowering

SWAPS

Barbell Bench Press, Machine Chest Press, Smith Machine Press

DB Shoulder Press

Upper · Front & side delts, triceps, upper chest · Equipment: Adjustable bench, dumbbells

SETUP

1. Set the bench upright (about 80–90°).
2. Kick the dumbbells up to shoulder height, palms facing forward or slightly in.

EXECUTION

1. Press up and slightly in until your arms are nearly straight.
2. Lower until the dumbbells are about ear level.
3. Keep your ribs down and your back on the pad.

CUES

- Ribs down
- Press up and in
- Forearms vertical

COMMON MISTAKES

- Arching the back to turn it into an incline press
- Lowering too far and losing tension
- Clanking the dumbbells together

EASIER / HARDER

Machine Shoulder Press / Standing DB Press

SWAPS

Machine Shoulder Press, Arnold Press, Landmine Press

Face Pulls

Upper · Rear delts, upper back, rotator cuff · Equipment: Cable, rope

SETUP

1. Set the pulley at upper chest to face height and attach a rope.

EXECUTION

1. Pull the rope toward your eyebrows, splitting it apart.
2. Rotate your hands back so your knuckles face the ceiling at the end.
3. Return slowly.

CUES

- Elbows high
- Pull apart

COMMON MISTAKES

- Too heavy
- Leaning back

EASIER / HARDER

Band face pull / Pause at the end

SWAPS

Rear Delt Fly, Band Pull-Apart

Glute Bridge

Glutes · Glute max, hamstrings · Equipment: Mat, band or dumbbell optional

SETUP

1. Lie on your back with knees bent and heels about 6 inches from your glutes.

EXECUTION

1. Brace your core and drive through your heels to lift your hips.
2. Squeeze your glutes at the top for 2 seconds.
3. Lower with control.

CUES

- Ribs down
- Heels heavy

COMMON MISTAKES

- Arching the lower back
- Feet too far away

EASIER / HARDER

Shorter range / Banded or single-leg bridge

SWAPS

Hip Thrust, Frog Pumps

Goblet Squat

Legs · Quads, glutes, core · Equipment: Dumbbell or kettlebell

SETUP

1. Hold a dumbbell vertically against your chest, elbows pointing down.
2. Feet slightly wider than hips, toes slightly out.

EXECUTION

1. Sit down between your hips, keeping your chest up.
2. Let your elbows track inside your knees at the bottom.
3. Drive up through your whole foot.

CUES

- Elbows inside knees
- Chest tall

COMMON MISTAKES

- Heels lifting
- Rounding forward

EASIER / HARDER

Box Squat to a bench / Pause at the bottom or heavier weight

SWAPS

Leg Press, Smith Machine Squat

Hip Abduction Machine

Glutes · Glute med, glute min, upper glute max · Equipment: Hip abduction machine

SETUP

1. Set the start position so your legs begin together with tension on the pads.
2. For more glute focus, lean your torso forward over your thighs and hold the sides of the seat.

EXECUTION

1. Push your knees out against the pads as far as you can control.
2. Pause briefly, then return slowly — don't let the weights slam.
3. On the final set, finish with partial reps at the outer range until failure.

CUES

- Lead with your knees
- Slow on the way in
- Lean forward for upper glutes

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the stack bang between reps
- Using momentum from the torso
- Cutting the range short on every rep

EASIER / HARDER

Lighter weight with full range / Lean-forward version + 10 partials at the end

SWAPS

Banded Seated Abduction, Cable Hip Abduction, Side-Lying Hip Raise

Lat Pulldown

Upper · Lats, mid-back, biceps · Equipment: Lat pulldown machine

SETUP

1. Adjust the thigh pad so your legs are locked in snugly.
2. Grab the bar slightly wider than shoulder-width with an overhand grip.

EXECUTION

1. Lean back about 10–15° and lift your chest.
2. Pull the bar to your upper chest by driving your elbows down toward your back pockets.
3. Squeeze your lats for a moment, then let the bar rise slowly until your arms are straight and your shoulders stretch up.

CUES

- Elbows to back pockets
- Chest up to meet the bar
- Full stretch at the top

COMMON MISTAKES

- Pulling with the arms and biceps only
- Swinging the torso back for momentum
- Pulling the bar behind the neck
- Cutting the stretch at the top

EASIER / HARDER

Band-Assisted Pull-Up or lighter weight / Pull-Ups or 3-sec lowering

SWAPS

Assisted Pull-Up, Single-Arm Cable Pulldown, Pull-Ups

Leg Press

Legs · Quads, glutes, adductors · Equipment: Leg press machine

SETUP

1. Sit with your back and hips flat against the pad.
2. Place your feet high and wide on the platform for more glute and hamstring, or mid-platform for quads.

EXECUTION

1. Release the safety handles.
2. Lower the platform until your knees are deeply bent — stop before your hips roll off the seat.
3. Press through your heels without locking your knees hard at the top.

CUES

- Hips stay down
- Heels heavy
- Control the bottom

COMMON MISTAKES

- Lowering so deep the lower back rounds off the pad
- Locking out knees forcefully
- Tiny half reps with huge weight

EASIER / HARDER

Lighter load, shorter range / Single-leg press or pause at the bottom

SWAPS

Hack Squat, Goblet Squat

Lying Hamstring Curl

Legs · Hamstrings · Equipment: Lying leg curl machine

SETUP

1. Lie face down with the pad just above your heels and your knees just off the edge of the bench.
2. Hold the handles and press your hips into the pad.

EXECUTION

1. Curl your heels toward your glutes as far as possible.
2. Squeeze, then lower over 3 seconds to a full stretch.

CUES

- Hips glued down
- Slow on the way down

COMMON MISTAKES

- Hips lifting off the pad
- Jerking the weight up
- Short range of motion

EASIER / HARDER

Lighter weight, slower tempo / Single-leg curls

SWAPS

Seated Leg Curl, Stability-Ball Hamstring Curl, Nordic Curl (advanced)

Machine Chest Press

Upper · Pecs, triceps, front delts · Equipment: Chest press machine

SETUP

1. Adjust the seat so the handles line up with your mid-chest.

EXECUTION

1. Press the handles forward without locking hard.
2. Return slowly until you feel a stretch in your chest.

CUES

- Shoulder blades back
- Control the return

COMMON MISTAKES

- Seat too high or low
- Shoulders rolling forward

EASIER / HARDER

Lighter weight / Single-arm press

SWAPS

DB Chest Press, Push-Ups

Romanian Deadlift

Glutes · Hamstrings, glute max, spinal erectors · Equipment: Barbell or dumbbells

SETUP

1. Stand tall holding the bar or dumbbells in front of your thighs, feet hip-width.
2. Unlock your knees slightly — they stay at this bend for the whole set.
3. Pull your shoulders back and down and brace your core.

EXECUTION

1. Push your hips straight back like you're closing a car door with your glutes.
2. Let the weight slide down the front of your thighs, staying close to your legs.
3. Lower until you feel a strong hamstring stretch — usually mid-shin. Your back stays neutral.
4. Drive your hips forward to stand, squeezing your glutes at the top without leaning back.

CUES

- Hips back, not down
- Weight stays glued to your legs
- Proud chest, long spine

COMMON MISTAKES

- Squatting the weight down (bending the knees more)
- Rounding the lower back to reach the floor
- Letting the weight drift away from your body
- Hyperextending at the top

EASIER / HARDER

Dumbbell RDL with a shorter range, or Cable Pull-Through / Single-Leg RDL, Deficit RDL, 3-sec lowering

SWAPS

Dumbbell RDL, Good Morning, 45° Back Extension

Seated Cable Row

Upper · Mid-back (rhomboids, traps), lats, rear delts · Equipment: Cable row station, V-handle

SETUP

1. Sit with feet on the platform and knees slightly bent.
2. Grab the handle and sit tall with a neutral spine.

EXECUTION

1. Pull the handle to your belly button while driving your elbows back.
2. Squeeze your shoulder blades together at the end of each rep.
3. Return slowly, letting your shoulders reach forward slightly for a stretch without rounding your lower back.

CUES

- Sit tall
- Elbows back, chest proud
- Squeeze a pencil between your shoulder blades

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rocking the torso back and forth
- Shrugging the shoulders up
- Rounding the lower back

EASIER / HARDER

Machine Row / Pause 2 sec at the squeeze

SWAPS

Chest-Supported Row, Single-Arm DB Row, Machine Row

Single-Arm DB Row

Upper · Lats, mid-back, rear delts · Equipment: Bench, dumbbell

SETUP

1. Place one knee and the same-side hand on a bench, back flat.
2. Hold a dumbbell in the other hand, arm hanging straight.

EXECUTION

1. Pull the dumbbell toward your hip, driving your elbow back.
2. Squeeze your back at the top.
3. Lower slowly to a full stretch.

CUES

- Pull to your hip, not your chest
- Flat back

COMMON MISTAKES

- Twisting the torso
- Pulling with the bicep

EASIER / HARDER

Chest-supported row / Pause at the top

SWAPS

Seated Cable Row

Treadmill Incline Walk

Cardio · Cardio, glutes, calves · Equipment: Treadmill

SETUP

1. Set the incline to 8–12% and speed to 2.8–3.3 mph.

EXECUTION

1. Walk tall without holding the rails.
2. Keep a pace where you can talk in short sentences.

CUES

- Hands off the rails
- Tall posture

COMMON MISTAKES

- Leaning back on the handrails

EASIER / HARDER

Lower incline / Higher incline

SWAPS

Stair climber, outdoor hill walk

Tricep Rope Pushdown

Upper · Triceps · Equipment: Cable machine, rope

SETUP

1. Set the pulley high and attach the rope.
2. Stand tall with your elbows pinned to your sides.

EXECUTION

1. Push the rope down until your arms are straight.
2. Spread the rope ends apart at the bottom and squeeze.
3. Let your forearms rise slowly to just past 90°.

CUES

- Elbows glued to your sides
- Split the rope
- Only your forearms move

COMMON MISTAKES

- Elbows drifting forward
- Leaning over the rope and using bodyweight

EASIER / HARDER

Band Pushdown / Single-arm pushdown

SWAPS

Straight-Bar Pushdown, Overhead Tricep Extension

Day 1 · Machines

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Learn phase · Guided machines: zero guesswork.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	✓
Leg Press 2 × 12 · RIR 3–4 · 75s			☐
Lat Pulldown 2 × 12 · RIR 3–4 · 75s			☐
Machine Chest Press 2 × 12 · RIR 3–4 · 75s			☐
Lying Hamstring Curl 2 × 12 · RIR 3–4 · 75s			☐
Hip Abduction Machine 2 × 12 · RIR 3–4 · 75s			☐
Treadmill Incline Walk 1 × 10 min · RIR — · —			☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets _____

New PR? _____

Day 2 · Dumbbells

Date _____ Bodyweight _____ Energy (1–10) _____ Sleep (hrs) _____

Learn phase · Claim a bench and a set of dumbbells.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	✓
Goblet Squat 2 × 12 · RIR 3–4 · 75s			☐
DB Chest Press 2 × 12 · RIR 3–4 · 75s			☐
Single-Arm DB Row 2 × 12 /side · RIR 3–4 · 75s			☐
Romanian Deadlift 2 × 12 · RIR 3–4 · 75s			☐
DB Shoulder Press 2 × 12 · RIR 3–4 · 75s			☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐ Total sets _____ New PR? _____

Day 3 · Cables

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Learn phase · Learn the most versatile station in the gym.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	✓
Cable Kickback 2 × 12 /side · RIR 3–4 · 75s			☐
Seated Cable Row 2 × 12 · RIR 3–4 · 75s			☐
Face Pulls 2 × 12 · RIR 3–4 · 75s			☐
Tricep Rope Pushdown 2 × 12 · RIR 3–4 · 75s			☐
Glute Bridge 2 × 12 · RIR 3–4 · 75s			☐
Treadmill Incline Walk 1 × 10 min · RIR — · —			☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets

New PR?

Day 1 · Machines

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Own It phase · Guided machines: zero guesswork.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	✓
Leg Press 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2–3 · 75s				☐
Lat Pulldown 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2–3 · 75s				☐
Machine Chest Press 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2–3 · 75s				☐
Lying Hamstring Curl 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2–3 · 75s				☐
Hip Abduction Machine 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2–3 · 75s				☐
Treadmill Incline Walk 1 × 15 min · RIR — · —				☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets	New PR?

Day 2 · Dumbbells

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Own It phase · Claim a bench and a set of dumbbells.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	✓
Goblet Squat 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2–3 · 75s				☐
DB Chest Press 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2–3 · 75s				☐
Single-Arm DB Row 3 × 10–12 /side · RIR 2–3 · 75s				☐
Romanian Deadlift 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2–3 · 75s				☐
DB Shoulder Press 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2–3 · 75s				☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets

New PR?

Day 3 · Cables

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Own It phase · Learn the most versatile station in the gym.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	✓
Cable Kickback 3 × 10–12 /side · RIR 2–3 · 75s				☐
Seated Cable Row 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2–3 · 75s				☐
Face Pulls 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2–3 · 75s				☐
Tricep Rope Pushdown 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2–3 · 75s				☐
Glute Bridge 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2–3 · 75s				☐
Treadmill Incline Walk 1 × 15 min · RIR — · —				☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets	New PR?

Gym Bag

CHECKLISTS

- [ ] Water bottle (32 oz+)
- [ ] Headphones (charged)
- [ ] Workout playlist
- [ ] Today's workout open in this app
- [ ] Lifting straps or grips
- [ ] Ankle strap for cable kickbacks
- [ ] Mini resistance band
- [ ] Small towel
- [ ] Deodorant
- [ ] Hair ties
- [ ] Post-workout snack or shake
- [ ] Phone tripod (optional)

NOTES

Before Your First Visit

CHECKLISTS

- [ ] Book a free gym tour/orientation
- [ ] Choose a quiet time to go
- [ ] Read today's workout and watch the cues in the library
- [ ] Lay out an outfit you feel good in
- [ ] Pack your bag the night before
- [ ] Tell a friend your plan (accountability)

NOTES

Confidence Rituals

CHECKLISTS

- [ ] Play my hype song on the way in
- [ ] Review my plan in the parking lot
- [ ] Say my affirmation
- [ ] Walk in with shoulders back
- [ ] Journal after the session

NOTES

Confidence Journal

PROMPTS 1–2

What exactly makes me nervous about the gym? Naming it takes away its power.

What would I do in the gym if I knew nobody was judging me?

Confidence Journal

After my first session: how did I feel walking out?

What did I do this week that past-me would have been too nervous to do?

Confidence Journal

Which station felt most intimidating, and how did it go?

Write a letter to the woman who walks into the gym confidently three months from now.